

Glossary

Short, family-friendly explanations for the abbreviations and terms used in this site's tournament tables - written so a first-time reader never has to guess what a shorthand means. See ``docs/EDITORIAL_GUIDE.md``'s terminology rules for the list this page exists to satisfy.

Status: verified

Last reviewed: 22 August 2026

a.e.t.

Short for ****after extra time****. When a knockout match is still level after 90 minutes, two more 15-minute halves are played before anything else is decided. "a.e.t." next to a final score means that score is what stood after those extra 30 minutes, before any penalty shoot-out.

pens

Short for ****a penalty shoot-out****. When a knockout match is still level after full time - and extra time, where it was played - each side takes penalty kicks in turn until a winner is settled. "pens" next to a final score marks the shoot-out result that decided the match.

runner-up

The team or player that finished second. This site always says "runner-up", never "second winner" - there is only one winner.

semifinalist

For UEFA EURO from 1984 onward, both teams eliminated in the semifinals are called semifinalists rather than ranked third and fourth. Unlike the FIFA World Cup, EURO has not played a third-place match since 1980, so there is no match result to separate them.

third and fourth place

For the FIFA World Cup, UEFA Nations League, and Copa América, the two semifinal losers play a separate match to decide third and fourth place, so those two positions are ranked rather than tied.

host

The country, or countries, that staged a tournament. Hosting does not grant an automatic spot in the tournament for most competitions covered here - a host still has to earn or qualify for its place the way any other team does.

confederation

One of football's regional governing bodies - UEFA for Europe, CONMEBOL for South America, and others for the rest of the world - each of which runs its own continental competition and allocates FIFA World Cup qualifying places to its member countries.